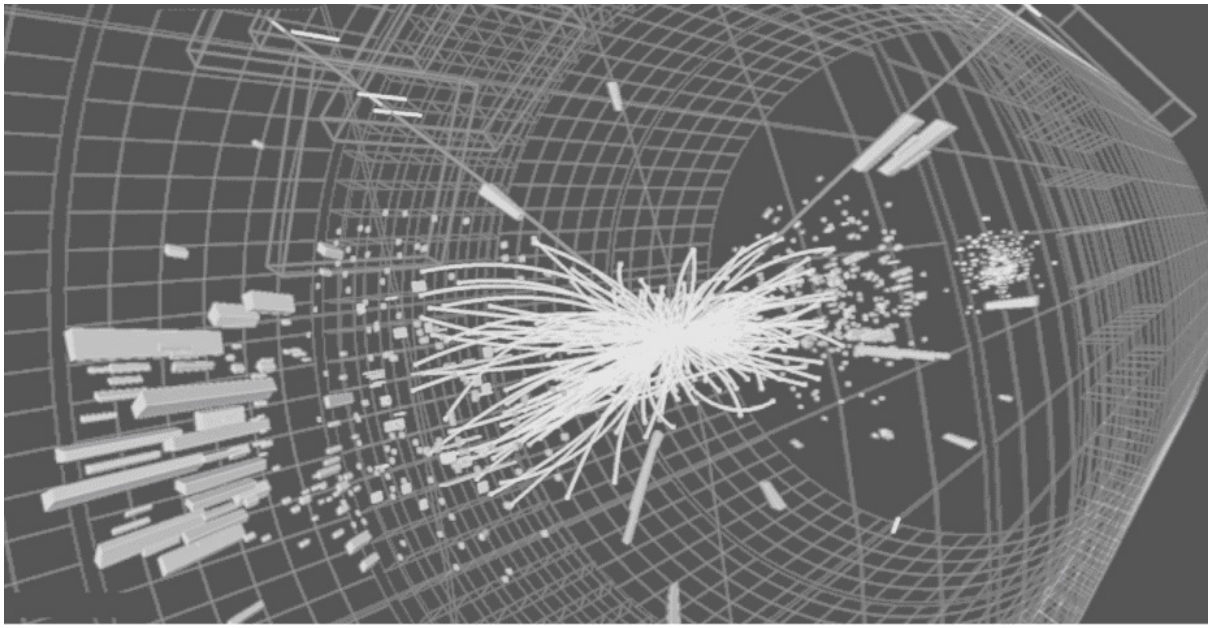


Figure 9.1 An event at CERN which shows the formation of the Higgs particle.

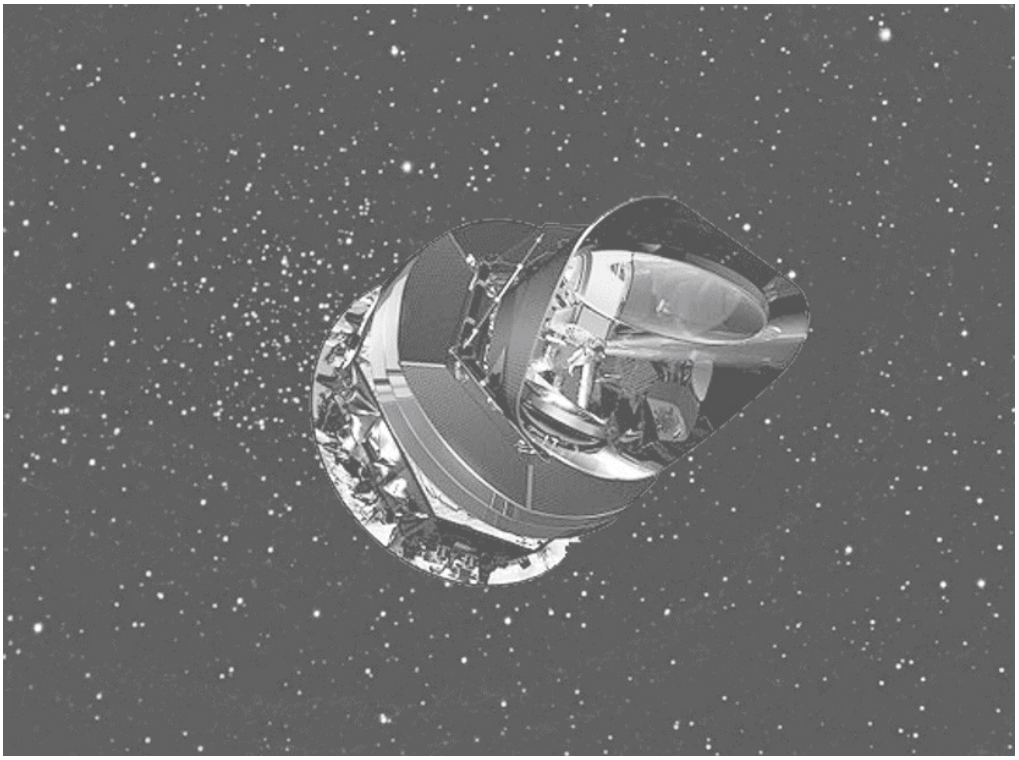


Figure 9.2 The Planck satellite.

There is something in common between these three results: the complete absence of surprise. This does not diminish their importance: if anything, it makes them even more meaningful. The discovery of the Higgs boson is a rock-hard confirmation of the validity of the ideas behind the standard model of elementary particles, based on quantum mechanics. It is the verification of a prediction made thirty years previously. The Planck measurements are a